Supplementary material: work with VS Code

VS Code is a code editor with Git built in: you can edit, commit, and push without leaving it. This exercise uses your `my_test_repo` repository.

Step 0. Prerequisites (only the first time)

- Download and install VS Code (https://code.visualstudio.com/)
- Download and install Git (https://git-scm.com/install/). VS Code does not use the Git that comes with GitHub Desktop, so Git needs to be installed separately
- Restart VS Code after installing Git

Note: Git uses the name and email you configured in GitHub Desktop. If VS Code asks you to configure `user.name` and `user.email`, check them in GitHub Desktop: File --> Options --> Git (Windows) or GitHub Desktop --> Settings --> Git (Mac).

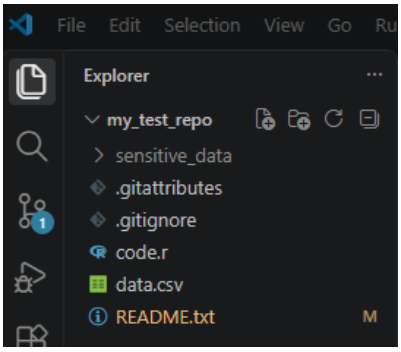
Step 1. Open your repository in VS Code

- In VS Code, go to File --> Open Folder... and select your `my_test_repo` folder
- If VS Code asks whether you trust the authors of the files, click “Yes, I trust the authors”

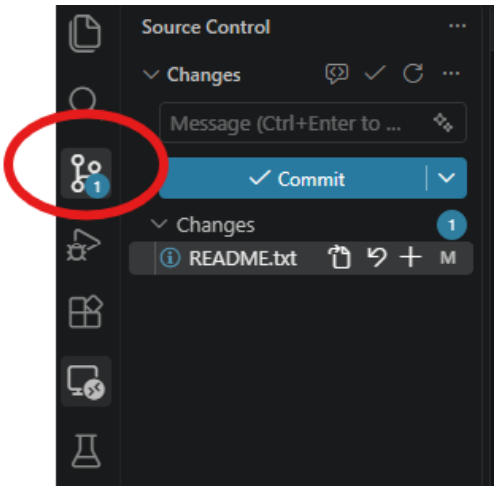
Note: You can also open it from GitHub Desktop: Right click on "Current repository" --> Open in Visual Studio Code. If this option is not available, select Visual Studio Code as your external editor in File --> Options --> Integrations (Windows) or GitHub Desktop --> Settings --> Integrations (Mac).

Step 2. Edit a file

- In the Explorer panel of VS Code (left), click on `README.txt`
- Add a line under “Notes”, for example “Edited with VS Code.”, and save (Ctrl+S / Cmd+S)
- The Explorer panel shows you that this file has been changed, with the name in orange and a small "M" for "Modified"



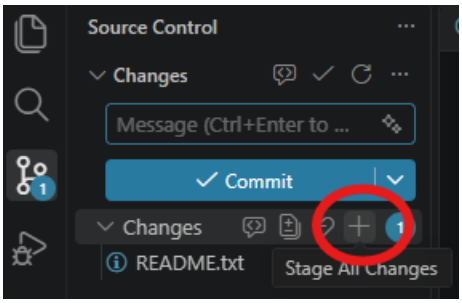
- Click on the Source Control icon in the left bar (or Ctrl+Shift+G / Cmd+Shift+G): `README.txt` appears with an “M” (modified)



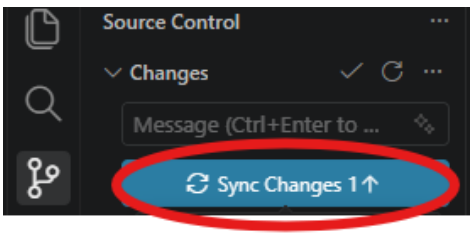
- Click on `README.txt` in this list to see what changed: removed lines in red, added lines in green

Step 3. Add, commit, and push

- Hover over `Changes` and click on the “+” icon. The file moves to “Staged Changes” (= it has been added to the file we want to commit)



- Write a message in the box above (e.g., “Add note from VS Code”) and click “Commit”
- Click “Sync Changes” to push your commit to GitHub



- The first time, VS Code might ask you to sign in to GitHub: click “Allow” and follow the steps in your browser

“Sync Changes” does two things: it pulls the new commits from GitHub (if any), and pushes yours.

Step 4. Check your commit

- Go back to GitHub Desktop and click on the “History” tab: your commit made in VS Code is there
- Open your repository on GitHub web: your change is there too

GitHub Desktop, VS Code, and GitHub web all work on the same repository. You can use whichever tool you prefer, and switch between them.